

Female sex organs

The female sex organs have two main functions. The ovaries store and release the eggs needed for sexual reproduction, while the uterus supports and carries a baby as it develops during pregnancy.

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◀ 30–31 Female hormones

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The menstrual cycle

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On the inside

The internal sex organs are located between the bladder at the front of the body and the rectum at the back. They include the uterus, the vagina, and two ovaries. Knowing the function of each part helps teens understand how the female body works and why females have regular periods.

▽ Internal sex organs

The primary function of the internal sex organs is sexual reproduction.

GOOD TO KNOW

Vaginal discharge

During puberty, females will start to notice a clear, yellow, or white fluid in their underwear. This fluid, known as vaginal discharge, is produced by the cervix. This discharge helps to clean and moisten the vagina, and to prevent infection. If, however, the fluid changes color, or is smelly, lumpy, or itchy, then speak to a doctor.

